

**The
Alan Turing
Institute**

Opportunities for Digital Humanists to move into Research Software Engineering

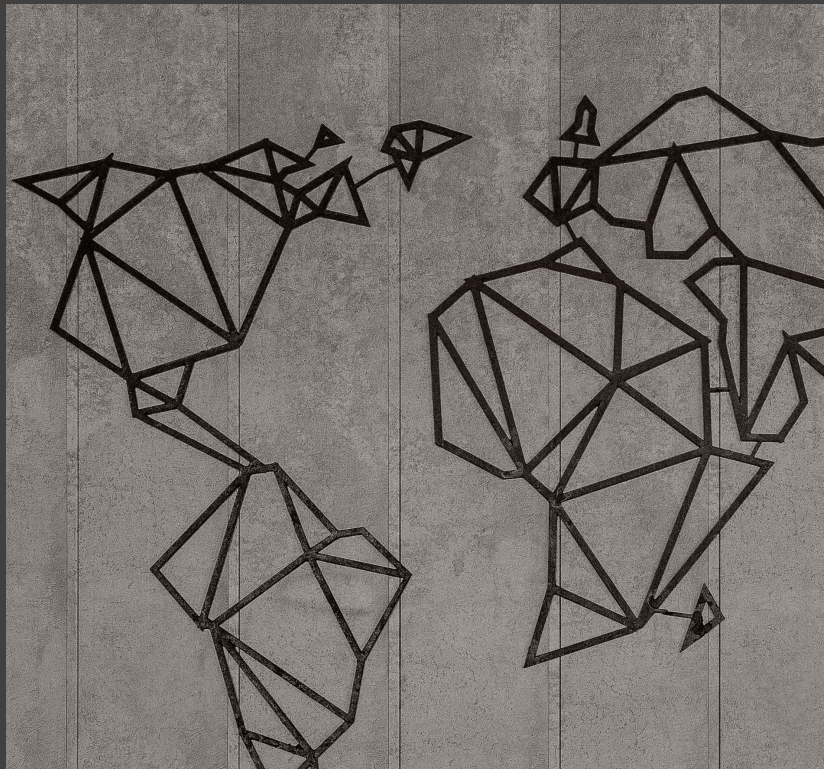
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DH RSE Summer School 2023-07-24

Outline

- Hellos 🖐️
- What's a Research Software Engineer do?
- Could you be an RSE?
- Where to go to join the RSE party 🎉



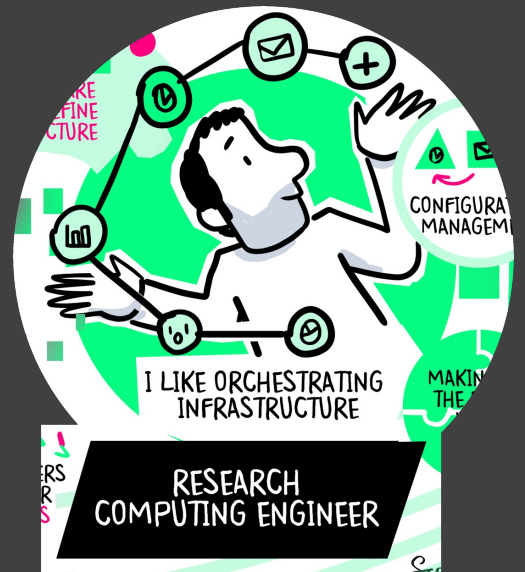
Hellos



David Beavan

- Lead Research Software Engineer
- Research Engineering Group
- The Alan Turing Institute
- turing.ac.uk





Research Software Engineer: The Craftsperson and the Scholar

– James Hetherington



RSE

- Coined in 2012
- First conference 2016
- Rapidly grown
- RSE groups
- Careers
- Strong identity

RSE in A&H

- Research projects grew in size and scope
- Interdisciplinary teams
- Greater digital assets
- RSEs make a difference



10 Signs you might be a Research Software Engineer





Quiz

- Interactive poll
- Keep your own tally of Yes vs No
- We will share at the end

Q: Do you want to
work in and around
research, not teaching
and admin?



Q: Do you want to
teach others new
practical skills, not
academic knowledge?



Q: Do you prefer a permanent job, not short term contracts?



Q: Do you enjoy
working in a variety of
challenges, not one
discipline?



Q: Do you want to
collaborate, not
compete?



Q: Are you
comfortable with being
assigned to projects,
not having your own
agenda?



Q: Do you want to
spend more time
developing software,
not conducting
research?



Q: Do you care about making software that works for others, not just you?

A graphic on the right side of the slide. It features a dark grey background with a diagonal line running from the top right to the bottom left. To the right of this line is a lighter grey area that looks like a piece of paper or a sign. On this sign, the words "GOOD", "VIBES", and "ONLY" are written in a bold, white, sans-serif font, stacked vertically. The sign has a slightly distressed or torn edge effect.

GOOD
VIBES
ONLY

Q: Do you care about software that is sustainable, not something that will fall apart quickly?



Q: Do you like to
invest energy to do
things properly, not a
rush job?





Quiz

- Tally up
- 8-10 This is for me, I dream in Python
- 5-7 I get it, I aint scared of Markdown
- 0-4 Not today, thx

From DH to RSE



RSE skills

- Knowing how RSEs contribute to a team
- Foundational RSE skills are wanted
- Rise of Digital Research Infrastructures



If you resource research software engineers and make funding contingent on modern, open, collaborative approaches to computational data science and code sharing, the [reproducible research] behaviours will follow

– Ben Goldacre



What A&H can bring

- Heterogenous data
- Missing data
- Uncertainty
- Multiple 'truths'
- Bias

Where to go to join the
RSE party 🎉





RSE-lite organisations

- Digital Humanities
adho.org/membership-individual
- digitalhumanities.slack.com
- UK-IE Digital Humanities
digitalhumanities-uk-ie.org

UK-Ireland Digital
Humanities Association
Research Software
Engineering in the Arts
and Humanities

- Brand new
- Get in at the start
(QR code will expire)





RSE organisations

- Research Software Engineers International
researchsoftware.org
- Software Sustainability Institute (SSI)
www.software.ac.uk

Society of Research Software Engineering (SocRSE)

- society-rse.org
- Professional body
- Funding schemes
- Mentorship
- Working groups





Activities

- DH conference
- RSECon conference
- Local groups
[society-
rse.org/community/regi
onal-groups](https://rse.org/community/regional-groups)
- Local tech socials

Jobs

- jobs.ac.uk
- SocRSE vacancies
society-rse.org/careers/vacancies
- Large employers
- Regional groups / conferences

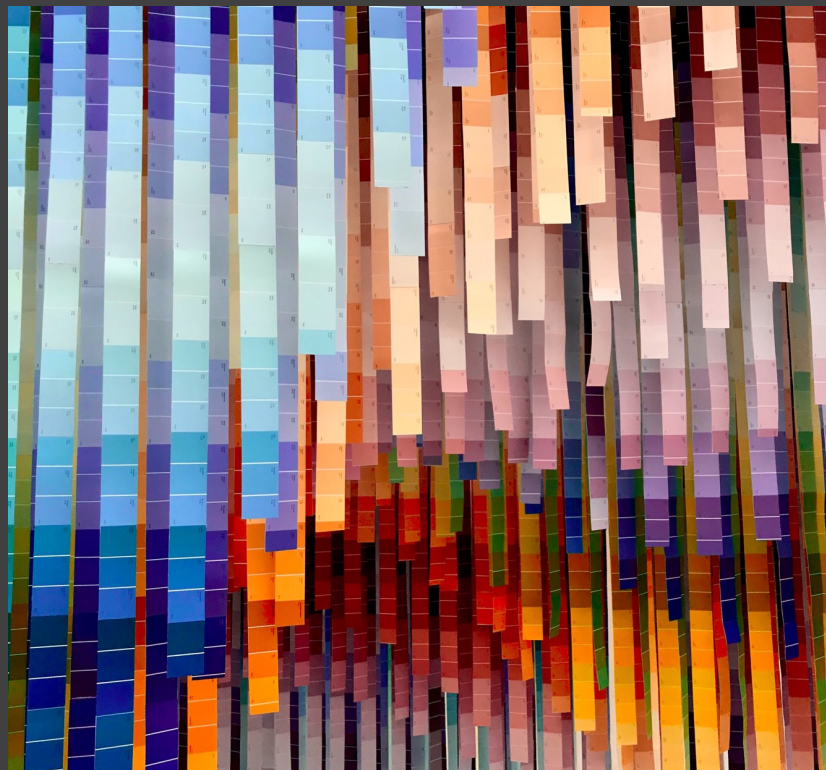


Q: This RSE thing.
Yes, it might be for me



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Thank you

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